



When Siri's a stand-up comic, and your fridge thinks it's Sherlock Holmes

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Ah, the age of Artificial Intelligence (AI). It is a time when our toasters are smarter than some politicians, and our fridges can predict when we'll run out of milk before we even remember it ourselves. It's a brave new world where our devices seem to know more about us than we do, and it's all thanks to the wonders of AI. But, dear readers, before we get too carried away with visions of our gadgets becoming our best friends, let's take a moment to examine the real impact of AI on consumer technology.

First, let's talk about the promises. AI was supposed to revolutionise our lives, making everything easier and more convenient. Remember when Siri and her AI companions were supposed to be the answer to all our problems? Now, Siri is more likely to misinterpret your question and suggest booking a table at a restaurant

halfway across the world. Thanks for nothing, Siri.

Then there are those AI-powered virtual assistants. You know, the ones that claim to be able to do everything from ordering groceries to managing your calendar. They were supposed to be the personal secretaries we never had. But in reality, they're more like those interns who don't quite get the job done right. Sure, they can set reminders and answer simple questions, but try asking them to draft a professional email, and you'll end up with something that looks like it was written by a hyperactive squirrel on caffeine.

Let's not forget about the predictive text, that wonderful feature that's supposed to guess what you're going to say next. It's like having a psychic keyboard, right? Well, maybe if your psychic is a bit drunk and has a penchant for bizarre word choices.

The predictive text seems to have a knack for turning simple messages into cryptic puzzles that even the most seasoned linguists would struggle to decipher. And do not get me started with text-based generative AI.

And what about those smart thermostats that promise to save you money by learning your heating and cooling preferences? In theory, they sound like a dream come true. In reality, they're more like a clingy ex who can't take a hint. Sure, they learn your schedule, but they also seem to think they know better than you do when it comes to setting the temperature. So, be prepared for your smart thermostat to turn your home into a sauna just as you're about to fall asleep.

Let's not forget the world of AI-driven content recommendation algorithms. They were supposed to personalise our online experiences and show us only the content we'd be interested in. But in practice, they seem to think we're a one-trick pony. If you once watched a cat video for a laugh, be prepared for your entire newsfeed to be flooded with cute feline content for the rest of your digital life.

Now, let's talk about facial recognition technology. It's been hailed as a breakthrough in security and convenience. But in reality, it's more like a creepy stalker with a camera. Facial recognition can't seem to tell the difference between identical twins, let alone distinguish between a face and a well-photoshopped picture. So, while it may keep your phone secure from strangers, it won't protect you from a determined cat burglar armed with a glossy magazine cutout of your face.

And let's not forget about AI-generated art. The idea that AI can create masterpieces on par with the likes of Picasso and da Vinci is laughable. Sure, AI can generate some intriguing patterns and designs, but calling it art is like putting a moustache on a potato and calling it the next Mona Lisa. Real